OLA OZERNOV-PALCHIK, Ph.D.

Research Assistant Professor, Boston University Wheelock College of Education & Human Development

Founder and Director, Evidence-Based AI in Learning (EVAL) Initiative

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OVERVIEW

Research focus: Cognitive neuroscience of language and literacy development in dyslexia and developmental language disorder; early identification and intervention; and the design and rigorous evaluation of AI systems that sense, model, and adapt to children's learning.

Current appointments: Research Assistant Professor at Boston University Wheelock College of Education & Human Development; Research Scientist at MIT's McGovern Institute for Brain Research.

Current leadership: Founder and Director of the Evidence-Based AI in Learning (EVAL) Initiative; Associate Director of Translational Research, Boston University AI & Education Initiative; President of the New England Research on Dyslexia Society.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Cognitive Science 2018
Tufts University, Department of Psychology/Applied Child Development, Medford, MA
Dissertation: Why Children Fail to Learn to Read: Identifying the Cognitive, Neural, and Environmental Precursors

M.S., Counseling (Summa Cum Laude) 2010
Southern Methodist University, School of Education, Dallas, TX

B.S., Psychology and Philosophy (Summa Cum Laude) 2006
Southern Methodist University, Department of Psychology, Dallas, TX

ACADEMIC & RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Research Assistant Professor 2024–Present
Wheelock College of Education and Human Development, Boston University, Boston, MA

Research Scientist 2023–Present
McGovern Institute, Department of Brain and Cognitive Sciences, MIT, Cambridge, MA

Senior Research Scientist 2022–2024
Wheelock College of Education and Human Development, Boston University, Boston, MA

Postdoctoral Associate 2018–2023
McGovern Institute, Department of Brain and Cognitive Sciences, MIT, Cambridge, MA

Faculty Director and Lecturer 2019–2022
Mind, Brain, and Education Master's Program, Harvard Graduate School of Education, Cambridge, MA

Graduate Research Fellow 2013–2018
Center for Reading and Language Research, Tufts University, Medford, MA

Research Coordinator / Graduate Research Fellow 2011–2015
Laboratories of Cognitive Neuroscience, Boston Children's Hospital, Boston, MA

Research Associate 2006–2011
Institute for Evidence-Based Education, Southern Methodist University, Dallas, TX

RESEARCH & PROGRAM LEADERSHIP

Founder and Director, Evidence-Based AI in Learning (EVAL) Initiative 2025–Present
Founded and currently leads a national research-industry collaborative of 10+ partner institutions that conducts independent, rigorous evaluations of AI-enabled educational tools. Supervises a team of researchers and coordinates external partnerships across academia, industry, and philanthropy.

Associate Director of Translational Research, AI & Education Initiative, Boston University 2025–Present
Leads translational research strategy advancing the evaluation, deployment, and policy-relevant use of AI technologies in education. Coordinates a cross-institutional team of 8+ researchers and external consultants.

President, New England Research on Dyslexia Society (NERDY) 2024–Present
Leads a regional research-practice organization advancing evidence-based approaches to dyslexia through rigorous scientific programming and stakeholder convening.

Advisory Council Member, NYC Public Schools AI Advisory Council 2024–Present
Advises the nation's largest public school system on responsible, evidence-based integration of artificial intelligence in education.

Scientific Advisor, Massachusetts Literacy Bill Implementation 2024–Present
Provides scientific guidance on the implementation of statewide literacy legislation, focusing on evidence-based screening and instruction.

Conference Organizer, The Dyslexia Foundation (TDF) 2023–Present
Leads scientific programming and speaker coordination for national conferences focused on dyslexia research and practice.

Founder and Director, Brookline Literacy Coalition 2022–Present

Founded and currently leads a community-based advocacy organization advancing evidence-based literacy instruction through educator engagement and policy advocacy.

Co-Organizer, Transforming K–12 Student Learning with AI Hackathon, MIT September 2025

Co-organized with Fabio Catania and Satrajit Ghosh, with support from the MIT Generative AI Impact Consortium; convened more than 40 educators, researchers, technologists, and students.

RESEARCH GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Major Grants and Initiatives — Active

2026 Tools Competition Prize, Renaissance Philanthropy Fund (August 1, 2026–January 31, 2028), Principal Investigator. KIVA (Knowledge Integration and Vocabulary Accelerator). $50,000.

Overdeck Family Foundation (2026–2028), Principal Investigator. Accelerating Rigorous, Decision-Relevant Evidence on AI-Enabled Learning Tools: Building a Generalizable Evaluation Infrastructure Through Early Literacy. $750,000.

Chan Zuckerberg Initiative, Reach Every Reader Phase 2 (R000003448; February 1, 2025–January 31, 2028; subaward from Florida State University), Boston University Principal Investigator. Development and Evaluation of a Multidimensional Risk and Resilience Screening Model for Reading Disabilities. $150,400.

Evidence-Based AI in Learning (EVAL) Initiative, Boston University (2025–Present). Founder and Director. Boston University internal award ($250,000) supporting the EVAL EdTech Evaluation Challenge, with additional institutional and philanthropic support for independent evaluation of AI-enabled educational tools. Coordinates a network of 10+ partner institutions across academia, industry, and policy.

Major Grants — Completed

Generative AI Impact Consortium at MIT (June 1, 2025–May 31, 2026), Co-Investigator. AI-Driven Tutors and Open Datasets for Early Literacy Education. $75,000, plus OpenAI API credits.

NRSA F32 (NIH/NICHD; F32HD100064; September 1, 2019–February 28, 2023), Principal Investigator. Neurocognitive Basis of Language Comprehension in Children with Dyslexia. $237,861, including supplements.

Jameel World Education Lab Grant, MIT (July 1, 2024–June 30, 2025), Principal Investigator. Bridging the Vocabulary Divide: Using Conversational AI Agents to Improve Reading Outcomes in Children from Disadvantaged Backgrounds. $79,989.

Pending Funding

NIH/NIDCD R21 (1R21DC024382). Dissociating Implicit and Explicit Vocabulary Learning Mechanisms in Developmental Language Disorder Using AI-Enabled Adaptive Conversational Tutoring. Role: Principal Investigator. Status: A1 resubmission, November 2026.

NIH/NICHD P20 (RFA-HD-27-006; prime: University of Notre Dame). NExT AI Hub: AI-Supported Precision Language and Literacy Instruction for Young Children With or At Risk for SLD. Role: Boston University Subaward Principal Investigator and Early-Career Investigator. Proposed period July 1, 2027–June 30, 2031; BU subaward $139,282 (total costs). Status: submitted October 2026.

Institute of Education Sciences, Phase II (prime: HILL for Literacy). Advisor: An Integrated Support and Decision-Making Platform for K–2 Literacy Educators. Role: Scientific Lead for AI Evaluation. Status: pending.

Other Submitted Federal Proposals

NIH/NICHD R21. Precision fMRI Investigation of Reading Comprehension and Content Knowledge. Role: Principal Investigator. Outcome: Not funded following Council review.

NIH/NICHD R21. Brain Mechanisms of Successful Remediation in Dyslexia. Role: Co-Principal Investigator. Outcome: Not funded following Council review.

Internal and Seed Funding

Ignition Award for Innovation, Boston University (2023), Co-Principal Investigator. AI-Inspired Multi-Tiered System to Enhance Core Reading Instruction. $75,000.

Red Hat Collaboratory Incubation Award (2023), Co-Principal Investigator. Open-Source Infrastructure for Secure Educational Data Management to Optimize Treatment and Identification of Students with Learning Disabilities. $75,000.

MIT International Science and Technology Initiatives (MISTI) (2018). Music training and reading-network development in preschool children.

Tufts Collaborates Seed Grant (2013), Co-Principal Investigator. Rhythm processing in early literacy development.

Barbara Evans Fellowship, Tufts University (2014–2017). Doctoral fellowship support.

RESEARCH TOOLS & DATA RESOURCES

KIVA (Knowledge Integration and Vocabulary Accelerator). Co-Developer and Principal Investigator. AI-enabled system designed to support children's vocabulary and knowledge development. sensein.group/riverst

Open-Source Educational Data Infrastructure. Co-Principal Investigator. Development of secure, open-source infrastructure for educational data management to support learning-disability identification and treatment, supported by the Red Hat Collaboratory (SECURE-ED).

Digital Twins for Educational Interventions (research in development). Principal Investigator. Using longitudinal data and high-density speech and tutoring-interaction data to model how children with different learning profiles respond to instruction. The longer-term goal is to develop and prospectively validate digital twins that simulate responses to alternative instructional approaches.

PACE (Probabilistic and Cumulative Evidence Estimator; proposed). Principal Investigator. Planned open-source tool for carrying evidence from one educational intervention study to the next, informing study design and updating estimates of learning effects and their variation across students and settings as new results become available.

Early Literacy Datasets and Models. Develops longitudinal data resources and benchmarks predictive models for early reading outcomes, with particular attention to incomplete school records and variation in performance across student groups. This work includes the NeurIPS Datasets and Benchmarks paper Scalable Early Childhood Reading Performance Prediction (2024; DOI: 10.52202/079017-2337) and ongoing multi-cohort benchmarking research. Data and code for the published work.

HONORS & AWARDS

2026 Invited Fellow, Think Forward Fellowship (2027–2028), Center on Reinventing Public Education (CRPE), Arizona State University. One of 40 education leaders shaping a field-wide agenda for evidence-informed decisions about AI tools in schools.

2019 IDA Early Career Researcher Award for Contributions to Research

2017 Flux Congress Science of Learning Symposium Winner

2016 First Place, Graduate Student Poster Competition, Tufts University

2016 Eliot-Pearson Doctoral Research-Practice Integration Award, Tufts University

2016 Outstanding Academic Scholarship Award Finalist, Tufts University

2015 Graduate Research Excellence at Tufts (GREAT) Fellowship, Tufts University

2013–2017 Graduate Student Travel Award, Tufts University

2006 Hausman Award for Excellence in Western Philosophy, SMU

2006 Psychology Department Senior Award for Outstanding Performance, SMU

2005 Alexander V. Mamontov Scholarship for Excellence in Russian Studies

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

[J.33] Olson, H. A.*, **Ozernov-Palchik**, O.*, Arechiga, X. M., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2026). Remote text-supplemented audiobook intervention supports children's explicit and incidental vocabulary learning. Developmental Science, 29(3), e70159. https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.70159

[J.32] Ozernov-Palchik, O.*, O'Brien, A. M.*, Lee, E. J., Richardson, H., Romeo, R., Poliak, M., Lipkin, B., Small, H., Capella, J., Nieto-Castañón, A., Saxe, R., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Fedorenko, E. (2026). Precision fMRI reveals that the language network exhibits adult-like left-hemispheric lateralization by 4 years of age. Nature Communications, 17, 6505. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-026-72916-5

[J.31] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Elizee, Z., Catania, F., Hacikamiloglu, M., Shattuck-Hufnagel, S., Petscher, Y., Ghosh, S., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2025). (Not so) universal literacy screening: A survey of educators reveals variability in implementation. Annals of Dyslexia, 75, 489–523. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11881-025-00342-1

[J.30] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Pollack, C., Bonawitz, E., Christodoulou, J. A., Gaab, N., Gabrieli, J. D. E., ... & Nelson, C. A. (2024). Reflections on the past two decades of Mind, Brain, and Education. Mind, Brain, and Education, 18(1), 6–16. https://doi.org/10.1111/mbe.12407

[J.29] Ozernov-Palchik, O.*, Qi, Z.*, Beach, S. D., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2023). Intact procedural memory and impaired auditory statistical learning in adults with dyslexia. Neuropsychologia, 188, 108638. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuropsychologia.2023.108638

[J.28] Treves, I. N., Olson, H. A., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Li, C. E., Wang, K. L., Arechiga, X. M., Goldberg, S. B., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2023). At-home use of app-based mindfulness for children: A randomized active-controlled trial. Mindfulness, 14(11), 2728–2744. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12671-023-02231-3

[J.27] Treves, I. N., Li, C. E., Wang, K. L., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Olson, H. A., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2023). Mindfulness supports emotional resilience in children during the COVID-19 pandemic. PLOS ONE, 18(7), e0278501. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0278501

[J.26] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Sury, D., Turesky, T. K., Yu, X., & Gaab, N. (2023). Longitudinal changes in brain activation underlying reading fluency. Human Brain Mapping, 44(1), 18–34. https://doi.org/10.1002/hbm.26048

[J.25] Davison, K. E., Zuk, J., Mullin, L. J., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Norton, E. S., Gabrieli, J. D. E., Yu, X., & Gaab, N. (2023). Examining shared reading and white matter organization in kindergarten in relation to subsequent language and reading abilities: A longitudinal investigation. Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience, 35(2), 259–275. https://doi.org/10.1162/jocn_a_01944

[J.24] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Sideridis, G. D., Norton, E. S., Beach, S. D., Wolf, M., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Gaab, N. (2022). On the cusp of predictability: Disruption in the typical association between letter and word identification at critical thresholds of RAN and phonological skills. Learning and Individual Differences, 97, 102166. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.lindif.2022.102166

[J.23] Beach, S. D., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., May, S. C., Centanni, T. M., Perrachione, T. K., Pantazis, D., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2022). The neural representation of a repeated standard stimulus in dyslexia. Frontiers in Human Neuroscience, 16, 823627. https://doi.org/10.3389/fnhum.2022.823627

[J.22] Ozernov-Palchik, O.*, Olson, H. A.*, Arechiga, X. M., Kentala, H., Solorio-Fielder, J. L., Wang, K. L., Camacho Torres, Y., Gardino, N. D., Dieffenbach, J. R., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2022). Implementing remote developmental research: A case study of a randomized controlled trial language intervention during COVID-19. Frontiers in Psychology, 12, 734375. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2021.734375

[J.21] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Beach, S. D., Brown, M., Centanni, T. M., Gaab, N., Kuperberg, G., Perrachione, T. K., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2022). Speech-specific perceptual adaptation deficits in children and adults with dyslexia. Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, 151(7), 1556–1572. https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0001145

[J.20] Centanni, T. M., Beach, S. D., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., May, S., Pantazis, D., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2022). Categorical perception and influence of attention on neural consistency in response to speech sounds in adults with dyslexia. Annals of Dyslexia, 72, 56–78. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11881-021-00241-1

[J.19] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Centanni, T. M., Beach, S. D., May, S., Hogan, T., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2021). Distinct neural substrates of individual differences in components of reading comprehension in adults with or without dyslexia. NeuroImage, 226, 117570. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuroimage.2020.117570

[J.18] Norton, E. S., Beach, S. D., Eddy, M. D., McWeeny, S., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Gaab, N., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2021). ERP mismatch negativity amplitude and asymmetry reflect phonological and rapid automatized naming skills in English-speaking kindergartners. Frontiers in Human Neuroscience, 15, 624617. https://doi.org/10.3389/fnhum.2021.624617

[J.17] Beach, S. D., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., May, S. C., Centanni, T. M., Gabrieli, J. D., & Pantazis, D. (2021). Neural decoding reveals concurrent phonemic and subphonemic representations of speech across tasks. Neurobiology of Language, 2(2), 254–279. https://doi.org/10.1162/nol_a_00034

[J.16] Zuk, J., Dunstan, J., Norton, E. S., Yu, X., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Wang, Y., Hogan, T. P., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Gaab, N. (2021). Multifactorial pathways facilitate resilience among kindergarteners at risk for dyslexia: A longitudinal behavioral and neuroimaging study. Developmental Science, 24(1), e12983. https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.12983

[J.15] Yu, X., Zuk, J., Perdue, M. V., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Raney, T., Beach, S. D., Norton, E. S., Ou, Y., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Gaab, N. (2020). Putative protective neural mechanisms in prereaders with a family history of dyslexia who subsequently develop typical reading skills. Human Brain Mapping, 41(10), 2827–2845. https://doi.org/10.1002/hbm.24980

[J.14] Centanni, T. M., Norton, E. S., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Park, A., Beach, S. D., Halverson, K., Gaab, N., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2019). Disrupted left fusiform response to print in beginning kindergartners is associated with subsequent reading. NeuroImage: Clinical, 22, 101715. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.nicl.2019.101715

[J.13] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Norton, E. S., Wang, Y., Beach, S. D., Zuk, J., Wolf, M., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Gaab, N. (2019). The relationship between socioeconomic status and white matter microstructure in pre-reading children: A longitudinal investigation. Human Brain Mapping, 40(3), 741–754. https://doi.org/10.1002/hbm.24407

[J.12] Ozernov-Palchik, O., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2018). Neuroimaging, early identification, and personalized intervention for developmental dyslexia. Perspectives on Language and Literacy, 44(3), 15–20.

[J.11] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Wolf, M., & Patel, A. D. (2018). Relationships between early literacy and nonlinguistic rhythmic processes in kindergarteners. Journal of Experimental Child Psychology, 167, 354–368. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jecp.2017.11.009

[J.10] Ozernov-Palchik, O., & Patel, A. D. (2018). Musical rhythm and reading development: Does beat processing matter? Annals of the New York Academy of Sciences, 1423(1), 166–175. https://doi.org/10.1111/nyas.13853

[J.9] Centanni, T. M., Norton, E. S., Park, A., Beach, S. D., Halverson, K., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Gaab, N., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2018). Early development of letter specialization in left fusiform is associated with better word reading and smaller fusiform face area. Developmental Science, 21(5), e12658. https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.12658

[J.8] Yu, X., Raney, T., Perdue, M. V., Zuk, J., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Becker, B. L. C., Raschle, N. M., & Gaab, N. (2018). Emergence of the neural network underlying phonological processing from the prereading to the emergent reading stage: A longitudinal study. Human Brain Mapping, 39(5), 2047–2063. https://doi.org/10.1002/hbm.23985

[J.7] Zuk, J., Bishop-Liebler, P., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Moore, E., Overy, K., Welch, G., & Gaab, N. (2017). Revisiting the "enigma" of musicians with dyslexia: Auditory sequencing and speech abilities. Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, 146(4), 495–511. https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0000281

[J.6] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Norton, E. S., Sideridis, G., Beach, S. D., Wolf, M., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Gaab, N. (2017). Longitudinal stability of pre-reading skill profiles of kindergarten children: Implications for early screening and theories of reading. Developmental Science, 20(5), e12471. https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.12471

[J.5] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Yu, X., Wang, Y., & Gaab, N. (2016). Lessons to be learned: How a comprehensive neurobiological framework of atypical reading development can inform educational practice. Current Opinion in Behavioral Sciences, 10, 45–58. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cobeha.2016.05.006

[J.4] Ozernov-Palchik, O., & Gaab, N. (2016). Tackling the early identification of dyslexia with the help of neuroimaging. Perspectives on Language and Literacy, 42(1), 11–17.

[J.3] Ozernov-Palchik, O., & Gaab, N. (2016). Tackling the "dyslexia paradox": Reading brain and behavior for early markers of developmental dyslexia. Wiley Interdisciplinary Reviews: Cognitive Science, 7(2), 156–176. https://doi.org/10.1002/wcs.1383

[J.2] Saygin, Z. M., Norton, E. S., Osher, D. E., Beach, S. D., Cyr, A. B., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Yendiki, A., Fischl, B., Gaab, N., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (2013). Tracking the roots of reading ability: White matter volume and integrity correlate with phonological awareness in prereading and early-reading kindergarten children. Journal of Neuroscience, 33(33), 13251–13258. https://doi.org/10.1523/JNEUROSCI.4383-12.2013

[J.1] Zuk, J.*, **Ozernov-Palchik**, O.*, Kim, H., Lakshminarayanan, K., Gabrieli, J. D. E., Tallal, P., & Gaab, N. (2013). Enhanced syllable discrimination thresholds in musicians. PLOS ONE, 8(12), e80546. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0080546

** Equal contribution.*

Peer-Reviewed Conference Proceedings

[C.1] Shangguan, Z., Huang, Z., Ohn-Bar, E., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Kosty, D., Stoolmiller, M., & Fien, H. (2024). Scalable early childhood reading performance prediction. Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems, 37 (Datasets and Benchmarks Track), 73487–73500. https://doi.org/10.52202/079017-2337

Preprints and Manuscripts Under Review

[P.2] Longhitano, G., Ng, I. D. M.-X., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Kim, H. J., Ohn-Bar, E., & Petscher, Y. (2026). TabLit: A demographic-aware benchmark for modeling early literacy outcomes. Manuscript submitted to ICLR 2027.

[P.1] Ozernov-Palchik, O., Catania, F., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Ghosh, S. (2026). Large language model–generated tutoring responses receive higher ratings but are penalized by source-based evaluation bias. PsyArXiv preprint, under review. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/stek7_v1

Manuscripts in Preparation

[M.4] Ozernov-Palchik, O., O'Brien, A., Mittal, S., Hogan, T. P., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. (in preparation). Precision fMRI reveals task-dependent reductions in language lateralization in dyslexia.

[M.3] Ozernov-Palchik, O., & Bready, M. (in preparation). Children's interactions with AI and human tutors during early literacy instruction.

[M.2] Ozernov-Palchik, O., & Mittal, S. (in preparation). The lateralization hypothesis of dyslexia revisited. Invited review for a TDF special issue.

[M.1] Ozernov-Palchik, O., King, M., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Ghosh, S. (in preparation). Multidimensional modeling and feature analysis of human and AI tutoring.

Book Chapters

[B.2] Gaab, N., Yu, X., & **Ozernov-Palchik**, O. (2018). Early atypical brain development in developmental dyslexia. In A. M. Galaburda, N. Gaab, F. Hoeft, & P. McCardle (Eds.), Dyslexia and Neuroscience: The Geschwind-Galaburda Hypothesis 30 Years Later (pp. 177–186). Brookes Publishing Co.

[B.1] Leon Guerrero, S., **Ozernov-Palchik**, O., Gonzalez, M., Zuk, J., & Gaab, N. (2019). Using tablet technology in preschool and early kindergarten for the identification of children at risk for reading difficulties. In N. Kucirkova, J. Rowsell, & G. Falloon (Eds.), The Routledge International Handbook of Learning with Technology in Early Childhood (pp. 393–403). Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315143040-28

SELECTED INVITED TALKS

2026

Implementation of State Literacy Policy: Considerations for Schools and Districts. International Dyslexia Association (IDA) DyslexiaCon 2026, Las Vegas, NV, November 12–14, 2026. (scheduled)

Language and Literacy Development: Neural Foundations, Early Identification, and Intervention. LI+TLE Lab Up & Coming Speaker Series, Emerson College, Boston, MA, November 3, 2026.

From the Reading Brain to Reading Practice: The Infinite Last Mile. Keynote, Leading Literacy Summit 2026: The Next Chapter in Evidence-Based Literacy, Science of Reading Center at SUNY New Paltz and EdTrust-New York, Albany, NY, October 14, 2026.

The Reading Brain in the Age of AI: An Evidence-Based Perspective. The Reading League, 10th Annual Conference, Hilton Chicago, Chicago, IL, September 30–October 2, 2026.

From the Reading Brain to Reading Practice: The Infinite Last Mile. Read Vermont Summit, Killington Grand Resort Hotel, Killington, VT, August 2026.

The Reading Brain in the Age of AI: An Evidence-Based Perspective. Big Sky Literacy Summit, Big Sky, MT, August 2026.

What Does AI Mean for the Developing Reading Brain? Big Sky Literacy Summit, Big Sky, MT, August 2026.

Precision fMRI of Language Network Development and Disruption in Dyslexia. The Dyslexia Foundation, 22nd Extraordinary Brain Symposium, El Convento, Old San Juan, Puerto Rico, June 2026.

EdTech as the Engine (panel with Hamit Hamutcu, Nina Huntemann, Mireia Torello, and Kachina Studer). Boston Tech Week (a16z), Boston, MA, May 2026.

Will AI Tutors Improve Learning or Make It Worse? What Schools and Innovators Should Consider (panel). AI in Edu Summit 2026, Northeastern University, Boston, MA, May 2026.

How Do You Evaluate and Select EdTech Tools: Three Perspectives from Three Experts (panel with Kaitlin Dumont and Rachel Schechter). AI in Edu Summit 2026, Northeastern University, Boston, MA, May 2026.

Neurocognitive Foundations of Literacy: Typical Development and Dyslexia. Center for Educational Neuroscience Applications (CENA), Bridgewater State University, Bridgewater, MA, April 2026.

(Not so) Universal Literacy Screening: The Leaky Pipeline from Identification to Instruction, and Can AI Help? Lunch & Lit Online Lecture, Right to Read, February 2026.

From brain to policy: Building evidence-based systems for better literacy outcomes. PREREQ Seminar, Boston University, February 2026.

2025

From early development to practice: The neurocognitive foundations of literacy. Child Mind Institute Visiting Professor Lecture Series, New York, NY, December 2025.

Explicit instruction to build vocabulary knowledge for reading comprehension. The Dyslexia Foundation Conference (TDF), Boston, MA, October 2025.

Navigating tomorrow: Embracing AI across the curriculum. Annual Zelma Wynn Symposium at the Summit School, Edgewater, MD, October 2025.

Neural systems underlying reading comprehension: Language and beyond. Big Sky Literacy Summit, Big Sky, MT, August 2025.

Developing vocabulary knowledge through text-supplemented audiobooks and scalable human and AI tutoring. Big Sky Literacy Summit, Big Sky, MT, August 2025.

Smart Start: Leveraging technology to detect and support learning differences early. Campaign for Grade-Level Reading (CGLR), Online, June 2025.

Reverse-engineering human tutoring: Building scalable AI for literacy. MIT Lincoln Laboratory, Lexington, MA, May 2025.

The neuroscience of reading: Tracing literacy from language to comprehension. Annual Zelma Wynn Symposium at the Summit School, Edgewater, MD, March 2025.

Reading to learn, learning to engage. Thriving in the Middle School Years: BU Wheelock Forum, Boston University, Boston, MA, February 2025.

2024

Neuroscience of reading. The Dyslexia Foundation Conference, MGH Institute of Health Professions, Boston, MA, November 2024.

Investigating the neurocognitive substrates of typical and atypical literacy development. University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, TX, November 2024.

2023

Harnessing Technology to Advance Education. XtraordinaryPeople, NYC, November 2023.

Towards Precise and Adaptive Education through AI Integration. Symposium on Improving the Lives of Families and Children, MIT, October 2023.

Open-Source Infrastructure for Student Learning Disability Identification and Treatment. Red Hat North America Research Interest Group Meeting, October 2023.

Cognitive and neural substrates of typical and atypical reading development. NWEA Meeting, March 2023.

Teaching Reading in Contentious Times: Panel Discussion. Brandeis University, Waltham, MA, September 2023.

2022

Reading development and developmental dyslexia. SHBT 205, Harvard University, MA, April 2022.

Neurocognitive mechanisms of individual differences in reading comprehension. Department of Psychology, University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT, March 2022.

Neurocognitive mechanisms of individual differences in reading comprehension. School of Education, Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL, February 2022.

Neurocognitive mechanisms of individual differences in reading comprehension. Educational Neuroscience, Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN, January 2022.

2021

Comprehending the same, differently: Neurocognitive processes in reading comprehension across development. Department of Psychology, Tufts University, Medford, MA, September 2021.

2020

Neural underpinnings of language comprehension in dyslexia. Laboratories of Cognitive Neuroscience, Boston Children's Hospital, Boston, MA, February 2020.

2019

From early identification to comprehension: Using neuroimaging to study reading. International Dyslexia Association, Portland, OR, November 2019.

Investigating contextual facilitation effects on phonological processing in children and adults with dyslexia. Communication Science Research Center, University of Cincinnati, November 2019.

2018

Why children fail to learn to read: Identifying the cognitive, neural, and environmental precursors. Safra Brain Research Center, Hebrew University, Jerusalem, Israel, October 2018.

Linking Rhythm Processing and Reading Development in Young Children. Engaged Learning Network at Games for Change Festival, New York, NY, June 2018.

Investigating contextual facilitation effects on phonological processing in children and adults with dyslexia. Haskins Laboratories, New Haven, CT, May 2018.

Insights from cognitive neuroscience into the development of the reading brain. Currey Ingram Academy, Nashville, TN, April 2018.

Cognitive links between rhythm perception and reading: A behavioral and neuroimaging investigation. Inaugural National Dyslexia Symposium, MIT, Cambridge, MA, February 2018.

2017

Neurological differences in dyslexia and literacy. The Dyslexia Foundation Conference, Harvard Medical School, Boston, MA, November 2017.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Courses Taught

Instructor, Interpreting Evidence in Educational Neuroscience 2023–2025
Harvard Graduate School of Education

Instructor, Seminar on Mind, Brain, and Education: Research Methods and Critical Topics 2019–2022
Harvard Graduate School of Education

Instructor, Reading Group on Research Methods in Educational Neuroscience 2021–2022
Harvard Graduate School of Education

Instructor, Learning and Attentional Disorders in Childhood 2017
Eliot-Pearson Department of Child Study, Tufts University

Guest Lectures in University Courses

From Early Development to Practice: The Neurocognitive Foundations of Literacy. Reading Wars course, Boston University (2025).

Cognitive Neuroscience of Dyslexia. Cognitive Neuroscience graduate course, University of Connecticut (2024).

Music, Reading, and the Brain. Graduate course, Harvard Graduate School of Education (2023).

Reading Development and Developmental Dyslexia. Undergraduate course, Department of Psychology, Tufts University (2022).

Links Between Rhythm Perception and Reading. Undergraduate course, Department of Music, Tufts University (2018, 2019).

Introduction to Neuroimaging. Graduate course, Eliot-Pearson Department, Tufts University (2016).

MENTORING & ADVISING

Mentored and advised over 30 undergraduate and master's students through research projects, thesis work, and academic advising.

EVAL Undergraduate Research Team, Boston University (2025–Present): trained 25 undergraduates in tutoring, fidelity coding of AI tutoring sessions, and product review

Master's Thesis Committee, Applied Child Development, Tufts University (2018, 2023)

Master's Student Advising, Harvard Graduate School of Education (2019–2022)

Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program (UROP) Mentor, MIT (2016–2023)

EDITORIAL SERVICE & PEER REVIEW

Associate Editor, Scientific Studies of Reading, 2025–Present

Ad Hoc Reviewer: PNAS, Cognition, Cortex, NeuroImage, Developmental Science, Developmental Psychology, Neurobiology of Language, Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience, Scientific Studies of Reading, Annals of Dyslexia, Learning and Individual Differences, Mind, Brain, and Education, Neuropsychologia

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (Organizer and Panelist), Tamer, M. (Moderator), Peisch, A., Tarca, K., & McCormick, M. From Right-to-Read Laws to AI Moratoria: How Should Education Policy Govern Classroom Adoption? Late-Breaking Roundtable, Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA, 2026.

Ozernov-Palchik, O., O'Brien, A., Hogan, T., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. Precision fMRI Reveals Functional Specificity of Right Hemisphere Recruitment in Children with Reading Disabilities. Society for the Scientific Study of Reading, Calgary, Canada, 2025 (symposium presentation).

Ozernov-Palchik, O., Olson, H., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. Reading ability and socioeconomic status differentially impact the vocabulary gains of children in a remote audiobook RCT. Society for the Scientific Study of Reading, Copenhagen, Denmark, 2024 (spoken paper).

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (Chair). Bridging educational practice and neuroscience to study developmental language disorders. Society for the Scientific Study of Reading, 2024.

Ozernov-Palchik, O., & Fedorenko, E. (Symposium Co-organizers). Unveiling the Neural Substrates of Early Language Development through Precision fMRI. Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Marseille, France, 2023.

Ozernov-Palchik, O. Examining selectivity and lateralization in the language network of children with dyslexia. Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Marseille, France, 2023 (symposium presentation).

Ozernov-Palchik, O., & Olson, H. Implementing Remote Developmental Research: A Case Study of an RCT Language Intervention during COVID-19. Society for Research on Child Development, 2023.

Ozernov-Palchik, O., Tartakovsky, N., Norton, E., Beach, S., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Gaab, N. Functional significance of familial risk for dyslexia: An activation likelihood estimation analysis. Human Brain Mapping, 2023.

Ozernov-Palchik, O., O'Brien, A. M., Romeo, R., Small, H., Lipkin, B., Capella, J., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Fedorenko, E. Development of the language network in the brain. Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Philadelphia, PA, 2022 (poster and poster slam).

Ozernov-Palchik, O., Centanni, T. M., Beach, S., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. Distinct neural substrates of subcomponents of reading comprehension. Cognitive Neuroscience Society, 2022.

Ozernov-Palchik, O., Norton, E. S., Wang, Y., Beach, S., Wolf, M., Gabrieli, J. D. E., & Gaab, N. The relationships among socioeconomic status, white matter microstructure, and pre-reading skills. Society for Neurobiology of Language, 2019.

Ozernov-Palchik, O., Brown, M., Norton, E. S., Georgan, W., Perrachione, T., Beach, S., Wolf, M., Kuperberg, G., & Gabrieli, J. D. E. Speech-specific perceptual adaptation in dyslexia. Society for the Scientific Study of Reading, 2019.

Ozernov-Palchik, O., Norton, E. S., Wang, Y., Beach, S. D., Wolf, M., Gabrieli, J. D. E., Patel, A. D., & Gaab, N. Early relationships between rhythm processing and prereading skills. Society for Music Perception and Cognition, 2017.

Ozernov-Palchik, O., Raschle, N. M., & Gaab, N. Distinct neuroanatomical regions of early reading abilities. Cognitive Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting, 2014.

CONSULTING & PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Member, Board of Advisors, HILL for Literacy	May 2026–Present
Member, Board of Advisors, Learning Ally	May 2026–Present
Scientific Advisor, The Dyslexia Foundation (TDF)	May 2026–Present
Judge, Education Track, Civic Hacks, Boston University	February 2026
Consultant, Massachusetts DESE, Dyslexia Screening Guidelines	2020–2026
Advisor to Brookline School Committee on Evidence-Based Literacy Practices	2020–2024
Consultant, National Center for Learning Disabilities, Dyslexia Screener Tools	2023
Consultant, XtraordinaryPeople, ML Classification of Disability Profiles	2023
Consultant, YokyWorks Foundation, Literacy App Efficacy Analysis	2022–2023

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Ph.D. Admissions Committee, Wheelock College of Education, Boston University (2025)

Ed.M. Admissions Committee, Harvard Graduate School of Education (2019–2021)

OPEN SCIENCE & RESEARCH PRODUCTS

GitHub: github.com/oozernov

Open Science Framework: osf.io/cf2z9

COMMUNITY OUTREACH

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2026). Your Amazing Brain. Orchard Garden K–8 Family STEM Night.

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2025). Demystifying Dyslexia. SEPAC, Canton, MA.

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2022). Dyslexia and Language-Based Difficulties. Brookline Literacy Coalition, Brookline, MA.

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2020). Dyslexia and Language-Based Difficulties. Brookline SpEd Partners Action Committee, Brookline, MA.

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2018). Neurological Differences in Dyslexia and Literacy. SEPAC, Medford, MA.

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2016). Research Evidence for Early Identification of Dyslexia. Presentation to Senatorial staff and state legislators, Boston, MA.

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2016). The Typical and Atypical Reading Brain. Professional Development Workshop for Teachers, University of Mississippi.

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2016). Tufts Talks. Faculty Presentation to Tufts alumni in New York, Washington, D.C., and Boston.

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2013). Your Amazing Brain. Interactive Workshop for K–2 Students at Hosmer School, Watertown, MA.

SELECTED PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP & MEDIA

2026

Holt, S., & Metz, J. (2026, October 23). Teaching and Learning in an AI World [Feature quoting Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. BU Wheelock Magazine. [Link]

International Centre for EdTech Impact. (2026, October 20). The EdTech Evidence Gap: Are Research Firms Part of the Solution or Part of the Problem? [Blog post featuring EVAL and Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. EdTech Partnerships. [Link]

Education Futures. (2026, October 5). Does It Really Work? Evidence Over Hype in EdTech [Podcast interview with Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. Hosted by Svenia Busson. [Link]

EdReports. (2026, September). AI in K-12 Instructional Materials: What We're Seeing [Report featuring the EVAL Collaborative's approach to independent evaluation]. [Link]

Boston University Experts. (2026, September 10). The Promise and the Risk: What a BU Expert Says About AI in Education [Q&A with Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. [Link]

Alicea, S., & McCormick, M. (2026, July 21). AI Is Rapidly Changing Education and Research Needs to Keep Up [Article citing Boston University's EVAL initiative]. Brookings. Republished by the Overdeck Family Foundation. [Link]

Tools Competition. (2026, June 23). 11 Winners Named: Accelerating K–12 Learning Track [Award announcement featuring KIVA]. [Link]

Michalowski, J. (2026, May 17). Language development in the brain [Research feature quoting Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. MIT McGovern Institute for Brain Research. [Link] Also published by MIT News (May 18) and Medical Xpress (May 18).

Orzech, O. (2026, May 12). AI, Literacy, and the Evidence Gap: Key Takeaways From Boston University on Amira Learning [Blog post discussing EVAL and an essay by Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. Amira Learning. [Link]

Michalowski, J. (2026, April 9). Learning with Audiobooks [Research feature quoting Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. MIT News. [Link]

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2026, March 13). Will AI Solve America's Reading Crisis, or Make It Worse? [Opinion essay]. The Boston Globe. [Link]

The Boston Globe. (2026, March 12). US literacy rates are shocking. Will AI save us? [Say More podcast interview with Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. [Link]

Hariri Institute for Computing, Boston University. (2026, March 3). Boston University's EVAL Collaborative Names Amira Learning Winner of Inaugural EVAL EdTech Evaluation Challenge [News release featuring Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. [Link]

The Boston Globe Editorial Board. (2026, February 26). Is Mass. really an educational leader when reading scores lag behind Mississippi? [Editorial quoting Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. [Link]

Trending in Education. (2026, January 16). Bridging Early Literacy, Brain Research, and AI Innovation with Dr. Ola **Ozernov-Palchik** [Podcast interview]. [Link]

The Science of Reading Formula. (2026). Podcast interview with Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**. Host: Malia Hollowell.

2025

Boston University. (2025, November 11). Expert: Literacy screening programs are failing young learners [Q&A with Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. Futurity. [Link]

Rivero, V. (2025, November 10). Evidence Over Hype: Building AI That Actually Works for Education [Interview with Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. EdTech Digest. [Link]

Thurston, A. (2025, October 29). Why Do So Many Kids Struggle with Reading? BU Researcher's Study Finds Literacy Screening Programs Failing Young Learners [Research feature]. The Brink, Boston University. [Link]

Trafton, A. (2025, October 29). Study: Identifying kids who need help learning to read isn't as easy as A, B, C [Research feature]. MIT News. [Link]

The Literacy View. (2025, August 8). Dr. Ola **Ozernov-Palchik** on Neuroscience, Literacy & Scalable Human + AI Tutoring | Big Sky Literacy Summit 2025 (Episode 133) [Podcast interview]. [Link]

Literacy Sparks. (2025, July 9). The Neuroscience of Reading and Dyslexia, Parts 1 and 2 (Episodes 20–21) [Podcast interviews with Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. [Link]

The Windward Institute. (2025, March 5). How Science Informs Policy and Practice of Reading with Dr. Ola **Ozernov-Palchik** [READ Podcast interview]. [Link]

2024

Dyslexia Uncovered. (2024, June 10). Ola **Ozernov-Palchik** — Neuroscience, Risk and Dyslexia [Podcast interview]. [Link]

The Ohio State University Inspire Podcast. (2024, April 17). Debunking myths about co-opted reading science [Panel interview featuring Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. [Link]

2021

Ozernov-Palchik, O., & Fein, M. (2021, December 12). Understanding the Reading Brain: Linking Research and Real-World Literacy Instruction [Recorded public talk]. Brookline Parents. [Link]

2020

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2020, November 12). McGovern Story Slam: Resilience [Recorded storytelling presentation]. MIT McGovern Institute for Brain Research. [Link]

The Economist. (2020, April 30). Closing Schools for COVID-19 Does Lifelong Harm and Widens Inequality [Media coverage]. [Link]

2019

Koperniak, S. (2019, June 27). Bridging the Gap Between Research and the Classroom [Event coverage featuring Ola **Ozernov-Palchik**]. MIT News. [Link]

Ozernov-Palchik, O. (2019, June 4). Lightning Literacy [Recorded research presentation]. MIT Science of Reading Symposium. [Link]

SCIENTIFIC MEMBERSHIPS

AAAI | AERA | SNL | SSSR | SMPC | SRCD | OHBM | CNS

LANGUAGES

English (native) | Russian (native) | Hebrew (native)